Meetings

In short

With a few changes, meetings can work better for neurodivergent people and people with anxiety. Send all the details before the meeting, and ask if anyone has access needs. Make meetings 5 to 10 minutes shorter, and tell people they can turn on captions.

What is it for?

Meetings are part of most workdays, and there are many ways to make them fully accessible and inclusive. This helps everyone, but it can be especially impactful for:

- Neurodivergent people
- People with anxiety
- People with learning disabilities

How to support it

Start with an inclusive meeting invite, such as this inclusive meeting invite template. Ask attendees whether they have any accessibility requirements, and let them know which accessibility features are available during the meeting. Give all the details about the meeting before it starts. This gives people time to prepare, read anything they need to, and understand what is being asked of them. Say whether it's a remote, hybrid, or in-person meeting, and whether the meeting will be recorded or not.

Some other things you can consider are:

- Give a short visual description of yourself for anyone who might be visually impaired. This is especially important for any meetings that will be recorded for future use
- Let everyone know your pronouns (you can also add them to your display name)
- Shorten your meetings by 5-10 minutes, to avoid anyone having no gaps between meetings
- Allow for people to move, doodle, fidget or stand during the meeting

- Let your attendees know that they can turn on closed captions or the meeting transcript (this is often hidden under 'More' in the meeting controls)
- Include breaks for meetings longer than an hour

Useful links

- University of Reading: Accessible meetings
- Top tips for hosting accessible and inclusive online events
- Accessibility tips for inclusive Microsoft Teams meetings and live events